No Deal

S&P −1.76% to lowest since September. Brent $108. Nasdaq enters correction. Trump walks back ceasefire signal.

THE SESSION

Wednesday's ceasefire optimism lasted exactly one session. The S&P 500 fell 1.76% to 6,475.71—its lowest close since September—after President Trump told reporters during a Cabinet meeting that he did not know whether the United States was "willing" to work with Iran on a deal. The remark erased whatever remained of the prior day's hope that a 15-point peace proposal might produce a framework before Saturday's deadline.

The Nasdaq shed 2.38% and closed in correction territory, down more than 10% from its October high. The Dow declined 1.01% to 45,960. The Russell 2000 fell 1.70%. The VIX rose 8.33% to 27.44. Brent crude surged 5.66% to settle just above $108 per barrel as the market repriced the duration of the Hormuz disruption, and WTI climbed 4.61% to $94.48. Treasury yields spiked across the curve as the oil-inflation transmission mechanism reasserted itself, compounding the pressure on risk assets.

The session's internal rotation was instructive. Energy was the clear winner: VLO surged 5.80%, CVX added 1.29%, and OKE gained 1.57%. Defense remained steady with LMT up 0.50% and GD up 0.79%. Semiconductors bore the heaviest losses as TurboQuant fears compounded the risk-off move: LRCX fell 9.35%, AMD gave back its entire 7.26% Wednesday gain to close down 7.49%, and TSM dropped 6.22%. Gold fell 3.44% to $4,395.60—the inverted safe-haven dynamic continues, with the dollar strengthening on oil-driven inflation fears and gold selling accordingly. Bitcoin declined 3.05% to $69,125.

ECB President Lagarde warned that the Iran conflict could force rate increases to contain reaccelerating inflation, characterizing the situation as a "real shock" and suggesting that markets were "overly optimistic." Separately, the OECD projected U.S. headline inflation at 4.2% for 2026—well above the Fed's 2.7% PCE forecast from the March dot plot—reinforcing the case that the rate path has shifted structurally higher.

IOWN Tactical: The five-day strike pause expires Saturday. The portfolio's energy and defense positioning absorbed today's repricing constructively. The S&P is now 5.7% below its 2026 high—not yet approaching the −20% buy-tranche threshold, but the drawdown is deepening with each failed diplomatic window. Discipline, not impulse.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

VLO +5.80% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Oil surge lifted refiners across the board. Brent settled above $108 after Trump walked back deal rhetoric. VLO led the Dividend sleeve and the broader energy sector.

MARA +3.62% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Rebounded despite Bitcoin declining 3%. Likely short-covering in crypto miners after recent heavy selling pressure.

FTNT +2.71% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Cybersecurity demand narrative strengthened as Stryker's restoration update and broadening Iran-linked cyber threats underscored the sector's relevance.

OKE +1.57% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Midstream benefited from the oil surge alongside refiners and producers. Pipeline volumes remain elevated with Gulf routing disruptions.

SYK +1.54% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Shares rose after confirming most manufacturing sites and critical production lines restored following the March 11 Iran-linked Handala cyberattack. Electronic ordering back online.

DECLINERS

LRCX –9.35% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

TurboQuant selloff deepened for a second consecutive day. Memory-adjacent semiconductor equipment names continued to absorb the repricing of AI memory demand expectations.

HUT –9.06% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Crypto miners sold off sharply as Bitcoin fell 3% and risk appetite contracted across speculative assets.

AMD –7.49% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gave back the entirety of Wednesday's 7.26% gain. Memory compression fears and rising rate expectations pressured the semiconductor complex.

TSM –6.22% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Foundry giant caught in the broad semi selloff. Samsung and SK Hynix also declined in Asian trading on continued TurboQuant concerns.

ETHA –5.79% — DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Ethereum proxy declined as crypto pulled back amid broader risk-off sentiment and dollar strength.

HOLDINGS NEWS

Stryker (SYK) restores manufacturing after Iran-linked cyberattack. Stryker confirmed Thursday that most manufacturing sites and critical production lines have been restored following the March 11 attack by Handala, an Iran-linked hacktivist group that

exploited Microsoft Intune to wipe data from over 200,000 employee devices. Electronic ordering systems are back online. The DOJ filed an affidavit noting the attack had direct impact on emergency medical services in Maryland. Shares rose 1.54% to $332.68.

NextEra Energy (NEE) holds flat as Morgan Stanley updates target. Morgan Stanley revised its price target on NEE, citing load growth from data center demand as a structural tailwind. Shares closed unchanged at $91.16 in an otherwise difficult session for utilities.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT ONE

–0.34%

vs. DVY +0.33% | IWS –1.20%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

–1.98%

vs. IUSG –2.82%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +4.84% vs DVY +6.29% / IWS +2.64%

Growth –3.65% vs IUSG –8.58%